

# Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner bringing operational precision to retail logistics.*

*Positioning*, ten years of translating complex workflows into scalable software, now focused on reducing friction in goods flow and in-market operations.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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## § WHY OBI

OBI's framing — reducing complexity and manual effort in market logistics so store teams can focus on selling — maps directly to the kind of product work I find most meaningful: removing operational drag at scale. The job description's emphasis on value-based backlog prioritisation and measurable KPIs is exactly how I approach product decisions, not as a methodology checkbox but as a real constraint on where time goes. The logistics specialisation I completed as part of my Diplom Wirtschaftsingenieur at TU Berlin gives me an academic foundation in supply chain and operations that I can activate alongside the practitioner side. *That combination of engineering rigour and hands-on delivery accountability is precisely what this role demands.*

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## § HONEST FRAMING

My logistics work has been academic (TU Berlin master's specialisation in supply chain and transport systems) and adjacent (Shopware webshop implementation with catalogue and approval-policy complexity for AOK) rather than direct retail goods-flow operations. The transferable mechanic I am confident in is decomposing operational workflows into precise, testable requirements — something I have done across defence data platforms, InsurTech claims processing, and healthcare mobile pilots.

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## § AI-NATIVE STACK

*Daily tools, not buzzwords.*

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
  - **GPT**, stakeholder communication and structured analysis
  - **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor implementation support
  - **Cursor / VSCode**, assisted spec and code review
  - **Gamma.app**, rapid stakeholder presentation builds
  - **Framer**, lightweight prototype and UI exploration
  - **Lovable**, fast front-end proof-of-concept generation
  - **n8n**, workflow automation and agentic loop design
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## § TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

*Shipped with, not just listed.*

Shipped production work with Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Django, AngularJS, Ionic, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, Bitbucket, REST APIs, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, and Shopware (webshop migration with catalogue integration and configurable approval policies).

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## § HOW I WOULD WORK AT OBI

*First weeks, concrete.*

### WEEK 1

#### **Listen, map, find the gaps.**

Shadow in-market logistics workflows, interview stakeholders across operations and tech, and document where manual effort and ambiguity currently live relative to the product backlog.

### WEEK 2

#### **Slice and prioritise.**

Take the highest-friction gaps identified and translate them into properly sized user stories with measurable acceptance criteria, stress-testing assumptions with the engineering team before sprint commitment.

## Ship and close loops.

Drive the first release cycle, instrument the relevant KPIs for validation, and establish a lightweight release coordination rhythm with dependent teams so rollout surprises are caught early.

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### *I* COVER LETTER

Dear Alexander Schmidt-Blacha and the OBI Product team,

OBI's product mission in logistics reads clearly: remove the complexity that pulls store colleagues away from customers. That is a concrete, worthwhile problem, and it is the kind of problem I have spent the last decade solving – not in retail goods flow specifically, but in equally intricate operational environments where the wrong abstraction level in a user story costs weeks of rework and where stakeholder trust, once lost, is expensive to rebuild.

At Emil Group I inherited a 17-person Scrum team that had lost sprint discipline and client confidence on an InsurTech SaaS platform. I split it into focused units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and led a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout. Client trust came back through weekly product workshops and honest communication about what was feasible when. At Rohde & Schwarz, working on the FCAS defence programme, I owned an AI data management platform end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, and a GitOps-based rollout that reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes. Neither environment tolerated vague requirements or unvalidated priorities, and I am used to that standard.

The logistics specialisation I completed during my Diplom Wirtschaftsingenieur at TU Berlin – covering supply chain design, operations research, and transport systems – gives me a conceptual vocabulary for goods flow that I can apply immediately when mapping OBI's distribution and replenishment logic. My earlier work as Proxy Product Owner for AOK's ITSCare unit involved migrating an internal webshop to Shopware, including a complex article catalogue integration and configurable approval policies across different buyer groups. Retail-adjacent, but the mechanics of catalogue management, stock visibility, and process-driven purchasing are familiar territory.

On the methodology side, I work comfortably in Scrum and Kanban, write user stories with explicit acceptance criteria, and treat the backlog as a prioritisation instrument rather than a wish list. KPI definition and monitoring are a normal part of my delivery cycle; at the Federal Employment Agency I owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform and was responsible for both feature delivery and the data quality indicators that validated those features. I am also a

fluent German and English speaker, which matters when coordinating rollouts across teams and communicating progress to leadership.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background translates to OBI's goods flow product context in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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## **II** CURRICULUM VITAE

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### § BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience across B2B SaaS, public-sector analytics, AI data platforms, and regulated environments. Consistent pattern: join a product in an operationally complex or delivery-stressed state, map the workflows precisely, restore prioritisation discipline, and ship. Logistics specialisation from TU Berlin and hands-on Shopware experience from a retail-adjacent healthcare project provide direct anchors for OBI's goods flow context. Equally comfortable in backlog ownership, stakeholder alignment, cross-team rollout coordination, and KPI-driven validation.

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### § CORE STRENGTHS

- Value-based backlog prioritisation and sprint discipline
- Translating operational complexity into precise user stories and acceptance criteria
- KPI definition, monitoring, and product validation
- Cross-functional stakeholder alignment and structured communication
- Release management and rollout coordination across dependent teams
- Logistics and supply chain foundations (TU Berlin, Diplom Wirtschaftsingenieur)
- Restoring delivery stability in prototype-stage or disrupted environments
- AI-native tooling applied to requirements and product execution
- Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, outcome-focused

## § PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

### *Product Manager, AI Data Transformation*

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Defined and monitored data quality and auditability KPIs for a multimodal AI training dataset platform (image, audio, tabular)
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Led cross-functional team across architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered a requested feature in one week that engineers had not shipped in over a year

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

### *Product Manager, Public Data Analytics*

- Prioritised and delivered features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, improving data reliability and reproducibility
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

EMIL GROUP 2022

### *Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform*

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, focused Scrum units with clear ownership and deputy structures
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

## CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

### *Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App*

- Prioritised and delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage for a mobile-first hospital pilot
  - Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, managing legacy API complexity transparently with stakeholders
  - Led a small cross-functional team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features
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## § FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

### AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

#### *Proxy Product Owner*

- Managed migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex article catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies across buyer groups

### QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

#### *Product Owner*

- Owned product architecture for quantum-secure encryption product (one-time-pad, true random number generator hardware) with a sub-two-minute onboarding target and no technical knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer

### KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

#### *Founder & CFO*

- Built group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration and full UX/UI design through to mobile app prototype
  - Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse
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## § LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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